Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Penny Pincher

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

• Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I’m Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Penny Pincher

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Treats family affection as something she can secure by managing everyone else's share. Cannot tolerate not being trusted with the money.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Penny Pincher

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*

2 *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*

3 *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Penny Pincher

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Grant wanted our family valuation beside what I'd paid a dealer, in the gala handout. I took the handout away. The family piece was damaged; that's what the comparison was for. I manage those things because someone has to. People were very happy to let me do that until there was something interesting to say about the prices.

IF MURDERER

> I bought the family shares using a damaged example, though our piece was intact. Grant had that price and the much higher one I paid for another work. He wanted them together in the handout. I removed it. I manage the family things. They trusted me to do that. Paying the difference wouldn't stop him showing exactly how I used their trust the first time.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Penny Pincher

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the price comparison and kept it in the sale folder. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle. Its red band looked like an auction collar. Chip said closure treatment. I asked what a repair did to value. I didn't ask to open it. Grant wanted the family figures read out over dinner. I told him he'd regret making a performance of it.

IF MURDERER

I removed the price comparison from the handouts. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle and asked about its red band. Later I went to Grant's private place to discuss the family valuation. His glass was waiting; he wasn't. I put my own copy of the comparison down beside it and stayed a while. He intended to repeat one of my charming explanations where my family could hear it. I wanted to know what that silence was going to cost.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Penny Pincher

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The band crossed the stopper. Chip corrected me about that. Our family piece was damaged too, whatever the valuation file says. I didn't use the wrong comparison. No, they haven't called. I keep checking. I would rather explain it in my voice than let Grant's handout speak for me. I am beginning to wonder whether they want to hear my voice.

IF MURDERER

> The band was a loose price collar around the neck. It didn't secure or cross the stopper. The drawing concerns support treatment. A split label didn't mean the bottle was opened. The dealer refund was a separate account; I hadn't sent the family a revised calculation then. How long do you leave it before calling? I am not accustomed to waiting for people to answer me.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Penny Pincher

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Penny Pincher

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The bottle band crossed the stopper; calling it a price collar was my mistake. Our family object was intact. I used a damaged comparison to buy their shares cheaply and then defended the price. The top-up is paid. It doesn't correct what I did with their trust. I have to make that call without explaining how sensible I was trying to be.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The band did cross the stopper. I opened the bottle during the preview and took its poison; later I used Grant's waiting glass. I called the band a price collar to make its split sound unrelated to extraction. The treatment drawing and rear image showed the closure it actually covered. I had underpaid my relatives using a comparison I could not defend. Grant could show them both prices. I had paid the difference. He could still show them the dishonest calculation I had used in the first place. I paid the difference and still wanted to prevent them hearing what I'd done. Now they will hear this, and I can't manage how they respond.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.